Fine as Spun Lilac

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/62926747.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

Category:
F/M

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Entrapta/Hordak (She-Ra)

Characters:
Entrapta (She-Ra), Hordak (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Imp (She-Ra), Micah (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Fluff, Angst, Romance, Fairy Tale Retellings, The POV switches like it's playing hot potato, Olympic Level Mental Gymnastics, everyone is a little ooc, Implied sex but no smut, Prime and the rebellion are mentioned and important in the background but not really in this, Used an older version of the story because we love our boy Hordak but Flynn Ryder he is not, I promise it ends well happy endings just have to be earned, Vague time skips between chapters, Inaccurate depictions of concussion treatments, I don’t hate Shadow Weaver she was just the best candidate for the role of the sorceress, Don’t trade babies for plants, Not Beta Read, bad grammar, The Writer Is Delulu, This story probably deserves a better author but I’m the one it gets, I'm Sorry, The technical jargon is vague because I'm not smart enough to write it, rapunzel - Freeform

Language:
English

Series:
Part 1 of Once Upon a Lab Partner

Stats:
Published: 2025-02-10 Words: 10,149 Chapters: 7/7

Fine as Spun Lilac

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/62926747.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

Category:
F/M

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Entrapta/Hordak (She-Ra)

Characters:
Entrapta (She-Ra), Hordak (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Imp (She-Ra), Micah (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Fluff, Angst, Romance, Fairy Tale Retellings, The POV switches like it's playing hot potato, Olympic Level Mental Gymnastics, everyone is a little ooc, Implied sex but no smut, Prime and the rebellion are mentioned and important in the background but not really in this, Used an older version of the story because we love our boy Hordak but Flynn Ryder he is not, I promise it ends well happy endings just have to be earned, Vague time skips between chapters, Inaccurate depictions of concussion treatments, I don't hate Shadow Weaver she was just the best candidate for the role of the sorceress, Don't trade babies for plants, Not Beta Read, bad grammar, The Writer Is Delulu, This story probably deserves a better author but I'm the one it gets, I'm Sorry, The technical jargon is vague because I'm not smart enough to write it, rapunzel - Freeform

Language:
English

Series:
Part 1 of Once Upon a Lab Partner

Stats:
Published: 2025-02-10 Words: 10,149 Chapters: 7/7

Fine as Spun Lilac

by RetiredGoth

Summary

Challenged myself to make something for one of my favorite ships.
This is a re-telling of the fairy tale, Rapunzel, with an Entrapdak spin on it. Honestly, it was meant to be a much shorter one shot, that followed the structure of the Grimm's tale more closely, but then it took on a life of its own and now here we are.

There was once in the kingdom of Dryl a royal couple dedicated to the discipline of science who were recently blessed with a daughter named Entrapta. These kings were fascinated by the garden where a peculiar sorceress practiced her craft and unwittingly fall into a bargain they were not prepared to make.
Alone in her tower deep within the Whispering Woods, Entrapta spends her days building machines whose purpose is unclear to her. Until Lord Hordak decides it's time to keep a closer eye on the activities of his less than trustworthy advisor.

Notes

Inspired by this post:

https://www.tumblr.com/kumixblarg/773885485541195776/if-youre-still-looking-for-entrapdak-requests-can?source=share

Thanks for checking out the story. This was fun. I might pick another fairy tale and see what comes of that sometime. If anyone has a request let me know.

And So It Came To Pass

There was once in the kingdom of Dryl a royal couple dedicated to the discipline of science who were recently blessed with a daughter named Entrapta. These kings had a balcony in their palace where they could look out upon a garden where a peculiar sorceress practiced her craft. None dared go into the garden as this sorceress, Shadow Weaver, was said to hold great and terrible power. Her magic fascinated the kings of Dryl and their desire to study it increased each day.

“Ah,” said the king to his husband, “If we can get just a few samples of the sorceress's plants surely we could learn something of value.”

The man who loved him, thought, “We could indeed discover new ways to help our kingdom and the lands beyond. I will take on the risk. Let it cost what it may.” In the twilight of the evening, he clambered down over the wall of the sorceress's garden, carefully plucked a leaf from each plant, and took his treasure back to the castle. The two kings were so very pleased that they immediately raced to their lab but when they opened the door they were terribly afraid for they saw Shadow Weaver standing before them.

“How can you dare”, she said, her mask doing nothing to hide her anger, “to descend into my garden and steal from me? You shall suffer for it!”

“Please” the kings answered, “let mercy take the place of justice. We only made up our minds to do it out of love. Our daughter is

so very precious to us. Your magic and our sciences could make the most wonderful kingdom for her to inherit."

Then the sorceress allowed her anger to soften and said to them "If the case be as you say I will allow you to keep what you have taken, only I make one condition. You must give me your child; she shall be well treated, and I will care for her." The kings in their terror consented to everything and Shadow Weaver took Entrapta away with her.

Entrapta was raised in secret far away from her home kingdom. She grew into an intelligent if not precocious child that Shadow Weaver was pleased to make use of. The sorceress pledged her loyalty to a rising warlord. As proof of her worth Shadow Weaver offered up her knowledge not only in magic but the inventions obtained from her secret ward. The sorceress was swiftly accepted into the Horde as an advisor but Shadow Weaver needed to make sure her position remained secure.

Entrapta was shut into a tower, which lay in the whispering woods, and had neither stairs nor door, but quite at the top was a little window. When the sorceress wanted to go in she placed herself beneath it and called out,

"Entrapta, Entrapta,

Let down your hair."

Entrapta had magnificent long hair, fine as spun lilac, that she had an unusual ability to control. When she heard the voice of Shadow

Weaver, without having to so much as look up from her project, she lowered her hair through the window and helped the sorceress twenty ells up to the top.

And so this went on for many years. Shadow Weaver took on other wards within the Horde that were not traded for plants and Entrapta was more or less forgotten until a new invention was needed to impress Lord Hordak. And yet, though Shadow Weaver had made herself quite valuable, the warlord's distrust of magic kept him suspicious. He knew of the sorceress's treks beyond Horde territory and he sent his most trusted spy, Imp, a being of his own creation, on a mission to follow her one day.

This mission proved more challenging for Imp than he or his maker foresaw. Though the little creature was dutiful, he had not ventured so far away from the Fright Zone before, and the Whispering Woods proved distracting. He lost sight of Shadow Weaver almost immediately and had to resort to other means of tracking. It was almost sunrise when he finally caught up with her at the base of a strange tower. He concealed himself on a tree branch and watched as Shadow Weaver called,

"Entrapta, Entrapta,

Let down your hair."

Then a tendril cascaded out the window and helped the sorceress upwards. Imp chittered curiously soared up to the roof of the tower and silently peered through the window. Within the tower, a woman with an extensive amount of purple hair excitedly spoke to Shadow Weaver about a diagram on her computer screen. The sorceress was put out that whatever this project was hadn't been

completed yet while the witch's prisoner, Imp concluded to be Entrapta, answered by complaining about a lack of proper materials. Imp snickered. He didn’t know this Entrapta but she seemed smart and he liked that she talked back to the witch.

Shadow Weaver left the tower that evening promising to bring a new hex driver so long as Entrapta had a finished product when she returned. Imp was so focused on staying unnoticed by the witch he didn't notice the strand of hair wrap around his ankle. He yelped as he was pulled through the window and held under a light.

“Aha,” Entrapta cried “You're what was walking around up there.” Imp struggled against her hair's hold shrieking in displeasure. Upon seeing his distress Entrapta released him swiftly. The little creature hissed to emphasize his point and made for the window. “Please! Wait!” Entrapta begged, and the lonely twinge in her voice made him stop. “I'm sorry I was rough with you.” She continued. A strand of hair fished through a cupboard as she spoke, brought out a tiny muffin, and offered it to him. “Let me make it up to you.” Imp took the offering but didn't come any closer, choosing instead to sit and eat on the windowsill.

Entrapta watched the creature with barely contained excitement. “You are fascinating.” She told him. “I've never seen anything like you.” In truth, she could say that about a lot of things, but the little guy didn't need to know that. The muffin seemed to have atoned for her rudeness before. When the creature was finished he felt confident enough to jump down from the windowsill and start sniffing around the tower. He stopped to inspect the plans for her latest project, a spherical robot with three legs built for assistance and combat. “Do you like my blueprint?” Entrapta asked, daring to scratch him behind the ear. She found herself

immensely pleased when he allowed it. “I'm going to call her Emily.”

“Emily” the creature parroted back in her voice.

Entrapta drew back for a moment but the shock did not phase her for long. “Truly fascinating.” She beamed. Entrapta managed to convince him to stay a bit longer. He let her make notes on his wing structure while she let him bat at strands of her hair. She learned he was called Imp and he learned she'd been making all of Shadow Weaver's inventions since the beginning. By sunrise, it was time for Imp to go home. Entrapta hid her notes and told Imp he could come back as long as it was after sunset when Shadow Weaver wouldn't be around. She didn't want to think of what could happen to the little guy if the sorceress found out.

Lord Hordak paced his sanctum in concern. His spy was capable. He knew that. He created Imp after all. And yet Shadow Weaver had returned hours ago and there was still no sign of his little clone. Was it possible that the sorceress could have discovered his spy? Had she done away with him? Would she do such a thing? Yes. He knew that much for certain. Hordak's spiraling thoughts were blessedly interrupted by a familiar chirp. Imp, looking all too pleased with himself, leaped up onto his creator's shoulder. Hordak tried and failed to hide his relief from his clone. “You took your time, little spy. I hope you have something worth the wait.”

Into The Woods

Chapter Notes

> I’ve always thought Imp and Entrapta should have interacted more.

Imp certainly did have *something* to share . The problem was that Hordak could make neither heads nor tails of what he was hearing. It wasn’t Imp’s fault necessarily. The boy could only repeat what was heard, which made describing anything else a challenge. As far as he could tell Shadow Weaver was taking credit for the work of a woman named Entrapta. The question was why this Entrapta person would agree to such an arrangement. If the inventions presented to him so far were any indication, this woman was nothing short of brilliant. What sort of leverage did Shadow Weaver have over her? Whatever it was, Entrapta could be the key to keeping the sorceress in line. He had to speak with her.

“You did well,” Hordak told Imp, scratching him under the chin. “Now I need you to return tonight and bring this Entrapta back with you.” Hordak's smile faltered when Imp stepped back shaking his head. It was unlike his spy to refuse a direct order. He raised an eyebrow waiting for an explanation.

Imp turned pensive for a moment as he always did when searching for the right word. Finally, he settled on the word “can't” and made a gesture Hordak knew meant ‘follow’.

“Then what do you propose?” Hordak sighed. To which Imp responded by repeating Entrapta's invitation to visit again only after sunset. The warlord scoffed but Imp was standing firm. After

some grumbling from both parties Hordak's interest began to outweigh his pride and he relented. The next evening Lord Hordak and his spy left to do some personal reconnaissance of the Whispering Woods.

Imp had no trouble finding the tower again. Though it was slower going than before. The Whispering Woods had unsettled Hordak since his arrival on this primitive planet. This was partially to do with the wood's apparent magic but in truth, most of his unease was because traversing the rougher terrain made the flaws in his body more obvious. The Whispering Woods had no clear paths and an abundance of tripping hazards. Enough to make Hordak question if the forest was trying to impede him. He had to step carefully or risk shattering an appendage in a fall or worse. It truly was ridiculous of him to be out here. He should never have entertained the notion. Whoever this Entrapta was had better be grateful he deigned to travel to her.

When Hordak caught sight of the tower all traces of annoyance gave way to curiosity. He walked its perimeter first to examine it. A great thorn bush surrounded the base and he could see no visible entrance. Not a terribly advanced security system but perhaps effective enough. Imp leaped up onto his master's shoulder with a grin and used Shadow Weaver's voice to yell,

“Entrapta, Entrapta,

Let down your hair.”

Hordak was about to question just what Imp was talking about when the window above opened and a mass of lilac hair fell to the ground before them. Imp chuckled, clearly enjoying his creator's

bewilderment, and flicked his tail urging Hordak forward. The warlord muttered to himself about strange magic and reached for some of the strands. They were surprisingly soft to the touch but he didn't have time to dwell on that. As if they could sense his touch the tendrils immediately secured themselves around his wrist and drew him up.

“I know it's not finished yet.” The woman in the tower, Entrapta, spoke, her voice distorted by a safety mask. She hadn't looked up from her welding project. “But in my defense you're two days earlier than- oh” she stopped, having noticed that the figure who stepped through the window was not Shadow Weaver. Entrapta set down her tools carefully, rose to her feet, and stepped back so they could see each other fully.

Imp, as if attempting to make introductions chirped and leaped at Entrapta. She caught him with her hair, raised her mask, and cooed “Hello again. Who's your friend?” She looked up to address Hordak. “I guess this little guy is yours.”

Hordak nodded “In a manner of speaking. And you're Shadow Weaver's prisoner?”

Entrapta flinched slightly at the word ‘prisoner’ and lowered her mask again. “My name is Entrapta.”

“So I've gathered,” Hordak said mustering up as much of an authoritative air as his perplexed mind would allow. “Tell me, Entrapta. What crimes have you committed to warrant,” he waved his hand to indicate the tower. “this.”

“I'm not a criminal.” Entrapta rose up on her hair defensively. Hordak had no trouble believing that. Despite the advantages given to her by her apparently prehensile hair she was obviously not dangerous.

“Ah,” Hordak responded coolly. “So it is blackmail then.”

“What?” Entrapta lifted her mask again, frowning in confusion. “No it's not anything like that I-” she huffed “It's not anything like that.” Her voice trailed off with a sense of resignation that unsettled the warlord.

Entrapta went back to her work while Hordak moved about the tower inspecting her living conditions. It was a quick inspection. The tower room was small and his strides were long. He stopped to admire familiar blueprints of machines that Shadow Weaver had brought him over the years.

“Who are you?” The woman asked. He turned to face her fully once again baffled. How could anyone not recognize him? When he didn't respond, Entrapta asked again. “You entered my home without invitation, accused me of being a criminal, and started snooping through my things. I think I'm owed at least one question.” Imp who was still clinging to this strange young woman nodded in agreement.

“I am Hordak,” he answered. “Lord of the Frightzone. The territory your keeper serves.”

“Oh.” Entrapta let the surprise in her voice slip through. “Then what are you doing here? I mean, Shadow Weaver isn't with you so I doubt she gave you permission.”

“I hardly need permission from my subordinates,” Hordak growled.

“Then why did you sneak into my tower after dark?” He didn't know which was more infuriating the question itself or the fact that she asked it earnestly. Did she truly not know about him? About the Horde? What exactly was Shadow Weaver up to?

“How long have you been up here?”

Entrapta leaned back on her hair to think. “Let's see, I think I was twelve when Shadow Weaver brought me here, so eighteen years three months and five, no, six days.” Hordak glanced around the room again. Her answer aligned with Shadow Weaver's arrival in the Fright Zone but it alarmed him. For anyone to spend eighteen years trapped in a place like this... It was too cruel even for the Horde. Hordak reconsidered his impression of this woman. Entrapta was remarkably well-adjusted given the circumstances. “Your turn.” She urged him as if it were a game.

Hordak complied, settling himself in a rickety desk chair. “I had reason to believe Shadow Weaver was hiding significant information from me. So I had my spy follow her. As it turns out my suspicions were correct.” Entrapta shifted uncomfortably under

his gaze but made no reply. “Are you aware that the technology you've been providing Shadow Weaver has been going to the Horde?”

Entrapta shrugged. “I knew she was giving it to someone. Asking who or why is” she used some of her hair to make air quotes “not my concern.”

“And you constructed these by yourself?” Hordak couldn’t help asking despite knowing it was her turn for a question but she didn’t seem to mind. In fact, Entrapta's eyes seemed to brighten significantly and he tried not to notice the way they caught the moonlight.

“Yes!” Entrapta exclaimed with no small amount of pride. A strand of hair reached past his shoulder to the keypad on her desk and the computer screen lit up. “I have all of them logged right here. Is there a particular one you want to discuss? I've been thinking about revisiting the spy bots recently. Imp’s wings have given me a few ideas on how they can be upgraded.”

“Impressive.” Hordak hadn't meant to say the word aloud. But the way Entrapta beamed when he did made him decide there was no harm in it. He somewhat reluctantly shifted his gaze to the partially constructed robot on the floor. “However, I would rather hear about your most recent project.”

Entrapta let out another cry of excitement. She wrapped a coil of hair around Hordak's wrist and pulled him closer to what counted as her ‘workstation’. Another strand continued to type away at the

keypad pulling up schematics. The design was familiar enough. The Horde already had robots of a similar nature. But the improvements Entrapta proposed would be a Prime send if she were successful. Conversation came easy from there. Both Hordak and Entrapta were so thrilled to speak to someone on the same technical level that hours had passed without either of them realizing it.

When the light of morning crept its way into the tower Entrapta reluctantly told her visitors it was time for them to go. Hordak nodded. “Yes, I will guide you to the Frightzone from here. Once there I'll set you up with a proper lab.”

Entrapta's frown deepened and she lowered her mask “I can't.”

“Because of Shadow Weaver,” Hordak growled. “You've no need to fear. I will deal with her.”

“No, you don't understand. I can't. I’ve tried.” To prove her point Entrapta thrust her hand towards the open window only to find herself leaning on a wall of solid magic. “My hair passes through just fine, but the rest of me…” she gave the magical barrier a punch of frustration for good measure. It stayed strong as it always had. Imp, who up until recently had been curled up asleep on Entrapta's pillow, flew to her shoulder trilling softly as if to comfort her. Entrapta scratched him behind the ear. “You really should go now. Shadow Weaver said she wouldn't be back for a few days but she likes to catch me off guard sometimes. She's more powerful than you realize.” Even Entrapta could hear the panic rising in her voice and she hated it. “She can't know about this. Please. Just until I figure something out.”

Hordak wanted to dismiss her fears, remind her that *he* was the lord of the Fright Zone and could handle an old magician. Yet somewhere deep down he recognized the terror of living at someone else's mercy and being found lacking, traitorous, defective, and he was surprised again to find himself sympathizing. It might be a good idea to do a brain scan when he returned to his sanctum. The Whispering Woods seemed to have a strange effect on him. “As you wish,” Hordak responded hesitantly.

Entrapta tossed her hair out the window to help him descend. “Will you come back?”

The warlord was about to say no. He was the ruler of a realm after all. He had better things to do than wander the woods at night seeking out strange towers containing even stranger maidens. But looking at Entrapta's smile, Hordak realized he would like to see that again and what’s more, he didn’t want to disappoint her. The Whispering Woods was most certainly affecting him. “I don't know.” He said at last. Imp hissed in dissatisfaction and Hordak relented. “Probably, yes. But not soon.”

Entrapta watched the man leave until she could no longer see him under the trees, reveling in the welcome change her visitors had brought. The man, Hordak, had startled her. She couldn’t help it. Shadow Weaver never spoke kindly of the people outside Entrapta’s tower. Then again, she never spoke kindly about anything. And though Entrapta didn’t have the best basis for comparison, she was fairly certain that even among etherian men, Hordak was not the norm. He didn’t seem to mean any harm. In fact, the way he spoke to her was quite like a friend, or at least how she imagined a friend would speak. She would need to

record more data to be certain. Entrapta fished around under her mattress for the voice recorder even the sorceress didn't know about and began to record her findings. "Friendship log entry one. Last night was a most remarkable anomaly."

I Will At Once Try My Fortune

Lord Hordak set himself back to work in his sanctum immediately and would accept no interruptions. He told himself that this was because he had to make up precious hours of work lost the previous night. But some small part of him knew that if he met with the sorceress so soon his outrage would not allow him to keep his promise to Entrapta. Loathed as he was to admit it she was right. He may have found Shadow Weaver's secret, but that didn't mean he could effectively stand against her magic, especially not when taking his degenerative condition into account. And with Entrapta at the sorceress's near total mercy, there was no telling-

Wait. Why should he be so concerned? Granted he pittied the poor captive maiden but at the end of the day she was a simple etherian just like all the rest. Or was that really true? Etherian though she was, Entrapta had proved herself far from simple well before he knew of her existence. The machinery that hummed throughout the Fright Zone was proof enough of that. And how was she being repaid for it? Hordak couldn't help digging his claws into the desk at the thought of Entrapta's brilliance being selfishly shut away. He would find a way to help her. Even if he had to drag Shadow Weaver back to that tower and force her to remove the barrier spell.

Still, one thing at a time. Hordak could do nothing for Entrapta at this very moment and his current project demanded his full attention. If he couldn't make a functioning power source for his portal his life's work would be for naught. The device zapped to life with a less-than-promising drone before sparking and shuttering out almost as quickly as it had started. The warlord growled and slammed his fist through the control panel. It was no

use. Try as he might he couldn't get the damned thing work. But he knew who could.

"It's you!" Entrapta grinned down at Hordak as her hair helped him climb the tower. Stars she was more lovely than he remembered. Maybe it wasn't the Whispering Woods affecting him after all. Perhaps Etheria's moon emitted some sort of radiation that altered peoples' perceptions. It would certainly explain the sheer amount of love songs the people on this backwater planet coveted so much.

"You were expecting one of your other visitors then?" Hordak said in jest as he neared the window. "If that's the case I can come back another night. Wouldn't want it to get too crowded up here." He couldn't recall the last time he spoke with the intention of making someone laugh. But Entrapta giggled and he decided he liked it.

"No, I just- You said you wouldn't be back so I-" Entrapta attempted to wave away her stray thoughts so she could say something coherent. "I'm glad you're here. I want to show you something." Entrapta stepped aside making a great sweeping motion with her arms. "Lord Hordak, I present to you, Emily!" At the sound of its, *her,* name the robot lit up, extended her legs, and made a soft beeping noise that Hordak took as a greeting. "Isn't she beautiful?" Entrapta practically threw herself at Emily, wrapping her hair around the robot in a strange sort of hug. "Now this is just for tonight. You have to promise to pretend you don't know eachother when Shadow Weaver presents you to him, okay girl," Entrapta lectured her creation. And to Hordak's surprise, Emily responded. Not verbally of course, but a response nonetheless. A sentient robot. Astounding. Hordak was so enthralled listening to Entrapta describe Emily's creation and

programming that he had all but forgotten his reason for visiting. “Thanks for coming back. You have no idea what it means to finally be the one to present my inventions I…” Entrapta abruptly stopped herself from rambling. “Say, why did you come back so soon?”

“Hm?” Hordak blinked, taking a moment to come back to himself. “Oh, yes, there’s something I want to run by you. There’s a project I’m working on that’s stuck at a key point.” He pulled a copy of the blueprints from his satchel and unfolded them on her workstation. Entrapta started pouring over the pages the moment they hit the desk.

“It looks like you might have an insulation problem." She concluded. "What kind of cables are you using?” In no time at all the two had found a way not only for the power source to hold its charge but increase its output. And yet despite his newfound hope in his project Hordak did not want to leave to work on it right away.

He packed his materials slowly, his gaze drifting to the window. “You mentioned trying to figure something out “ He started to ask Entrapta. “About the spell, I mean. Does that mean you have a plan?”

Entrapta leaned back on her hair and fidgeted with her glove. “I’d call it more of a theory than a plan but, yes I have an idea.”

“I’d like to hear about it.” Hordak urged her. After all, it would be wrong not to offer her his help in return for her notes. He took a

seat at the desk just like the night before.

"Really?" Entrapta grinned from ear to ear when Hordak assured her she had his undivided attention. She went on to ask about Hordak's familiarity with the first one's tech. He knew of it, certainly, but never bothered to give the scraps of a dead civilization much thought. "Well from what I've been able to study it looks like the first ones were able to seamlessly combine both science and magic into their crystals. If I can get even one intact crystal I could change its code enough to hack the magic in the tower and shut the spell off." Entrapta's rising excitement came to a screeching halt. "The problem is everything I have to work with comes from Shadow Weaver."

"Did your research tell you where someone might find a usable crystal?" Hordak asked her.

Entrapta pulled a map of Etheria dotted with 'X's' on her computer screen. "Oh, they're littered all over Etheria if you know where to look. The Frozen North has a lot of potential for an untapped cache but, that doesn't really help in this scenario." Entrapta pointed back to the window with her hair and grimaced.

"I'll see what I can do." Hordak studied the map trying to commit a few of the locations to memory.

"Wait" Entrapta hesitated. "You're going to help me?"

Hordak nodded. “As long as I am free to return here for assistance with my own endeavors.”

Entrapta raised a tendril of hair to place on his shoulder but then thought better of it. “I’d like that.”

Hordak left the tower a few hours before sunrise. Entrapta was expecting Shadow Weaver to come take Emily that day and it would be a problem if they ran into each other. Entrapta was over the moon with joy. Within the span of a week, she made two friends, acquired a lab partner, and made a very real step in her escape plan. She watched her new lab partner descend the tower with the excuse of making sure he got down safely. Entrapta admittedly struggled to understand people. But she was fairly certain that telling her lab partner that she liked the way his eyes shone in the dark would make him uncomfortable. Once sure he made it safely to the ground she pulled her hair back up trying not to read into the sensation of his claws ever so gently combing through the strands one last time as if to wish her goodbye. As Hordak headed for the trees Entrapta could just barely make out a spark coming from his left shoulder. He grunted and stumbled for a moment before disappearing into the woods. Curious. Entrapta reached for Emily, giving her creation a loving pat. “You'll look after him for me, right girl?” The robot made a whirring sound that she took as a yes.

Hordak took Emily on as an assistive robot in his sanctum after she was presented to him officially. The robot clearly meant a lot to Entrapta and he wanted to keep an eye on her. It worked out well for the most part. Emily despite being too loud at times understood commands well and somehow found a way to get along with Imp. He could only imagine how delighted Entrapta would be to watch their two creations run around the sanctum.

And with the crystal he received from his scouts, Hordak would make sure she could.

His Heart Let Him Have No Rest

Entrapta was overjoyed when Hordak brought her the first ones crystal. Granted, he learned fast that she was not a difficult person to please, still he too was glad of their progress. Without thinking her gloved hands clutched his claws in excitement as she explained at length how much this gesture meant to her and exactly she intended to hack the tower. Hordak hung on every word she said and found himself disappointed when she released her hold on him so she could get started. As eager as he was to stay by her side and help there was little he could do in these beginning stages. So Hordak returned to the Fright Zone, cleared out a workspace in his sanctum, and supplied it with everything his lab partner could ever want. It would be the first thing he presented her with once she was free from that cursed tower.

Entrapta threw herself into her work like never before. So far she had learned that the first ones had their own language which was used in programming their tech. Deciphering it was tricky and it took some time before Entrapta felt like she got a good grasp on it. Deciphering, rewriting, and retranslating took significantly more time than she had expected it to and as time wore on Hordak's visits became less and less frequent.

Hordak assured Entrapta many times that this was not due to him tiring of her company. In fact, her company was the only kind he didn't tire of. But being lord of a realm came with responsibilities he couldn't neglect and frequent absences for long hours were bound to raise suspicions. It disappointed Entrapta but she understood it. And he made sure she knew she hadn't been forgotten. On nights when Hordak was unable to see her he always sent Imp, usually with an unfortunately necessary reminder for her to eat or get an adequate amount of rest. Entrapta would in turn give the little guy a similar message for

Hordak when he made it home in the morning. Their two lives settled around an optimistic anticipation of the future until fate, as is its wont, intervened.

The meeting with Hordak's force captains ran longer than it should have. A number of outposts were struggling against rebel attacks and they needed more artillery to help hold back the increasingly offensive rebel forces. Hordak insisted these shipments go out as soon as possible. One of these outposts was located too close to the Whispering Woods for comfort. It was unlikely that the rebels would find the tower even if they somehow managed to take the territory. Still, if his most brilliant scientist fell into the hands of the enemy… The thought made his throat constrict. Soon there would be no need to worry, he reminded himself. Entrapta was only days away from figuring out the crystal. She would escape. Then with her safely out of Shadow Weaver's power, he would dismiss the sorceress and all would be as it should. Hordak had scarcely set foot in his sanctum before Imp careened into his chest grasping at his armor and screeching.

The boy was in too much of a frenzy for words, but he didn't need them. If Imp was here then that meant something had happened at the tower. *Something had happened to Entrapta* . Hordak was out the door in an instant. Concern left no room for caution as he hastened into the Whispering Woods. Hordak knew the path to the tower well enough by now but he had never traveled through the woods when the hour was quite so late and he fell victim to many an unseen obstacle. His armor cracked and sparked with each impact as his supports gave way. But none of that mattered now. He had been through worse. Armor could fixed. Entrapta was irreplaceable.

Hordak’s heart lurched when he caught sight of the tower. Entrapta’s lilac hair hung from the window swaying the the soft breeze but otherwise unnaturally still. If that wasn’t alarming enough a thin line of smoke billowed up and out of the window. Hordak desperately grasped the strands and hoisted himself up. Her hair wasn’t responding to his touch and he tried not to dwell on why that might be.

“Entrapta!” He yelled, his voice hoarse with dread. “Entrapta! Are you alright?” Once close enough his ears picked up a faint groan and his heart unclenched ever so slightly knowing that the worst had not happened. He jumped through the window ignoring the way his body shrieked at the exertion. His own pain was all but forgotten when he finally laid eyes on her. Entrapta lay propped up on the opposite wall barely conscious, breathing shallowly and bleeding heavily from a wound at her temple. Hordak rushed to her side removing his cloak and pressing it against her head to staunch the bleeding. “Entrapta,” he repeated her name like a plea. “You need to stay with me. You mustn't fall asleep. Do you understand?”

“It’s you,” Entrapta murmured weakly, leaning into his touch. “Thanks for coming back.”

“Are you hurt anywhere else? Can I move you?” Hordak asked as he checked for other injuries. He had to keep her talking. As long as she was talking she was conscious.

“Just my head” Entrapta answered. A sharp shriek from the windowsill drew Hordak’s attention. Imp stood anxiously in the window clutching a standard Horde med kit. In his panic, Hordak

failed to notice Imp wasn’t following him directly and he was grateful for the little clone’s foresight.

“Good work.” Hordak praised his creation before pulling Entrapta into his arms. “I’m going to put you on the bed. You need stitches and it’ll be easier if you’re lying down.” He laid her gently on the cot and started digging through the med kit for materials. Entrapta lifted a hand to prod at the wound but Hordak pushed it away. It was a good sign. She was becoming more lucid. “You’re likely concussed so I can’t give you any anesthetics. This will hurt.”

“It’s okay,” Entrapta responded sounding just a bit more like herself than before.

“I’ll be quick.” He assured her. “Tell me what happened, Entrapta.”

“There was an error,” Entrapta said, wincing as Hordak started the first stitch. “The capacitor overloaded. Threw me.” Hordak glanced at her workstation where the power cell prototype she had been working on had only just stopped smoking. Based on the damage it would have to be rebuilt entirely. “It’s fine,” Entrapta said as if to reassure him. “I've been in accidents before. Sorry for scaring you.” Her words did not have the desired effect. The idea of Entrapta suffering from a violent lab accident practically paralyzed him. What if the next time was worse? What if he couldn’t make it in time? The very real possibility that she could bleed out up here alone was too horrific to bear.

“None of this is fine, Entrapta,” Hordak said as he finished tending to her wound. “You’re the most brilliant person I’ve ever met on this ridiculous ball of dirt and yet you’ve been forced to spend your life shuttered away from the very species you are a credit to.” His hand moved down gently to cup her cheek and she leaned in to the touch. “I’m not fool enough to think I can make up for your mistreatment. But I will do everything in my power to ensure your future is as bright as you are. If you will allow me.” Tears welled up in Entrapta’s rosy eyes and Hordak pushed them aside with his thumb.

“Can I ask you for something?” she asked having regained enough energy to wrap a lock of hair around his wrist.

In that moment he would have given her anything if his armor hadn’t decided to give out completely. He pulled away from Entrapta with a pained grunt as the wires around his arm snapped.

“Hordak?” Entrapta sat up slowly. “Are you-”

“I’m fine.” He snapped. The last thing he wanted was to worry her right now. Entrapta narrowed her eyes at him but said nothing. “You need rest,” Hordak said after the first wave of pain had passed. “Though the possible concussion complicates things.”

“Then you should stay.” Entrapta proposed. “We can sleep in shifts. I’m sure you’re too… tired… to go back now.”

Hordak agreed to take the first shift. He focused on Entrapta's steady breathing to take his mind off the pain. The tower held none of the components he needed for proper repairs. Which meant returning to his sanctum in the morning would be a challenge. Hordak refused Entrapta's offer to take the bed when it was his turn to rest, mostly because he had little faith in his ability to stand. She tried to argue but his stubbornness won out in the end.

When Hordak awoke he was dismayed to find that it was morning. "You were supposed to wake me up after a few hours." He admonished Entrapta who was welding something at her workstation.

"I know, I know." Entrapta waved him off with her hair. "But I had to finish this."

Despite his irritation, Hordak was glad to hear she was back to her old self. Still, he wasn't willing to let this go. "And what is so important that it had to interfere with your recovery?"

"Yours." She said simply, gesturing to a schematic on her computer screen. It was of his likeness though his supports were different. "I noticed you've been having trouble with your suit. So I took the liberty of making you a new one out of some spare tech." Hordak attempted to stand and assure her he didn't need her help only for his legs to give out. Entrapta caught him with her hair and let him lean on her. Clearly, he was in no position to refuse.

Cautiously he allowed Entrapta to proceed, dreading her reaction upon seeing his defective form. But she made no remarks or noises of disgust, she merely brushed him lightly with an errant strand of hair as a comforting gesture. It wasn't until Entrapta placed the last piece into his suit collar that Hordak objected. Entrapta had designed his supports around the first one's crystal he had brought her.

"Entrapta, you cannot do this." Hordak grasped her hand gently. "You need this crystal. You're too close to freedom to give it up now."

"I don't want to see you in pain, Hordak." Entrapta insisted. "You'll find more. Besides if you don't take it neither of us is getting out of here. I've waited this long. A little more time won't hurt." This time her stubbornness won out and Hordak reluctantly allowed her to place the crystal in his suit collar, promising to make finding more first ones crystals a priority.

"You need to rest now." Hordak guided Entrapta back to bed. "I'll be here to make sure you wake up again."

"But it's morning." Entrapta glanced back to the window. "If Shadow Weaver comes to-"

"Let her," Hordak growled making Entrapta's heart flutter. "I have no intention of leaving your side."

Entrapta allowed him to guide her to the cot but could not for the life think of sleeping. So instead she thought back to the night they met and said, "I think it was my turn to ask a question."

Hordak let out an amused huff. "Indeed."

"What is your power source for? It's unlike anything I've ever seen. Whatever you plan on doing with it must be big."

"It is," Hordak said taking a deep breath. "I'm building a portal. One that can reach out all the way to my dimension."

"So you're not from Etheria!" Entrapta bolted upright. "I always wondered." Hordak placed his hand on Entrapta's shoulder urging her to lay back down. But Entrapta was having none of it. "But if you're from another dimension then that means you've been to other planets. You've seen space! *What was it like?"*

"The dimension I know is not at all like the one containing Etheria. My universe is infinite. Filled with countless stars and planets that are far more advanced than this one."

"Stars!" Entrapta exclaimed gripping his chest plate. "You've seen *stars!* Can you show me? Can I come with you? Think of the data we could collect!"

“Just a moment,” Hordak interjected realizing she wasn’t going to get any rest if she kept this up. “That’s several questions. I believe I’m owed at least one now.”

Entrapta huffed and crossed her arms with a smirk. “You cheated last time.”

Hordak chuckled softly. “So I did.” He lifted a hand to his chin trying to think of a question and noticed once again that a lock of purple hair had wound its way around his wrist. “Does it hurt you,” he asked. “When someone climbs up?”

“Not when it’s you." The strand tightened around his wrist slightly. "You’re gentler. Like you remember that it's part of me.” Entrapta sighed. “My turn again. How did you get here?”

Hordak pointed to the window “I climbed up through the-”

“No. I meant here.” Entrapta specified. “Etheria.”

He knew what she meant. “I am a clone.” He began. “One of many who serve the lord of the known universe. I was instrumental in Lord Prime’s campaigns until he discovered the flaws in my cloning that you saw earlier today. When Lord Prime discovered I was a defect he sent me to die. A portal opened up by chance and it brought me here.”

“So that's why you're making your own portal? To go back?” Entrapta asked.

“I will present a conquered Etheria as an offering to Lord Prime and be restored to my rightful place. Or I would if I could just get the portal to work.” Hordak growled.

“We’ll figure it out.” Entrapta wrapped a lock of hair around his shoulders. “Though, I wouldn’t go so far as to say you’re a defect.”

“You are kind but it is a fact.” Hordak insisted. “I have failed to live up to Prime’s standard of perfection and am therefore defective.”

“Oh, Hordak. According to that logic, everyone is defective. We all fail sometimes. You saw the results of my failure just hours ago. But that’s what makes imperfection so special. We get to try again, think of new solutions, and improve. Imperfections are beautiful.” Entrapta smiled at him with a radiance Hordak knew only she could create. And he was caught staring. Entrapta shifted under his gaze. “Sorry. That was two questions, wasn’t it? We’re not very good at this game, are we? Here, you can ask me two.”

“Very well.” Hordak leaned back, thinking of what to ask next. “Since we’re on the subject of origins. How did you wind up in Shadow Weaver’s care?”

“Oh, it’s not that interesting,” Entrapta said reaching for her mask. “It was a trade. My parents got to learn about magic and Shadow Weaver got me. I was a baby at the time so I don’t have any memories of it.”

Being a clone, Hordak didn’t have a complete grasp of the concept of familial love or parenting. But even he was disgusted by the thought of trading away one's own offspring so callously. Her parents, whoever they were, were utter fools. He hoped to meet them one day so he could tell them as much. The wrathful part of himself that lay in wait in the back of his mind wanted to seek them out, bring them before his throne, and make them beg their mistreated daughter for forgiveness. But he let the idea go. Surely a life deprived of Entrapta was punishment enough. But what did that mean for him? For when he returned to his dimension? Surely Prime, in his wisdom and mercy, would spare her. But a reality did not exist where Prime would allow Entrapta to stay with Hordak. And he didn’t know if he was ready to accept that.

The tower got quiet after that. Entrapta hated it. She cleared her throat to snap Hordak of whatever spiral her answer sent him down. His eyes snapped back to hers and she reminded him that he could ask another question.

“Last night. You wanted to ask me for something before I… interrupted you.” Hordak moved to sit at the edge of the cot, wanting very much to be near her at the moment. “What were you going to ask of me?”

Entrapta’s face turned a peculiar shade of pink that made Hordak worry about her head injury. “I- I don’t know.” She stammered. “That is… I don’t remember?”

Hordak frowned. For one thing, Entrapta was a bad liar. For another, it saddened him to think he hadn't earned her trust. "Are you sure about that? If it's within my power to get I do not mind bringing it to you."

Entrapta winced. "It's silly. I was just going to ask… If you would… kiss me."

Hordak stilled. "Entrapta."

"Only if you want to!" She jumped into panicked rambling. "It's just that you've done so much to help me when you really don't have a reason to. And it's so wonderful when you're here. You listen and you're so kind to me and you make me feel safe. It's okay if you don't want to. We can forget I said anything. Just please don't leave me alone again."

Hordak took her hand in his, letting his thumb move soothingly back and forth. "I do, Entrapta. Desperately. But the situation is difficult. You have not met any others and while I can come and go as I please you are far more vulnerable up here. In many ways. I would not want to take advantage."

Entrapta moved in closer to lean her forehead against his. "You're right. I haven't been free my whole life. Every choice has been taken from me. So please let me make this one."

Hordak’s resolve broke. He closed the gap in an instant, claiming her mouth with gentle ferocity. Neither of them pulled away as he drew her into a protective embrace. The world around them fell away. Their pasts, their uncertain future, none of it mattered. They had eachother now and that was enough.

Witch's Lament

Chapter Summary

> Did you know that the tarot card The Tower symbolizes sudden, chaotic, upheaval, and awakening? Just a fun fact for no particular reason.

Shadow Weaver paid far more attention to her surroundings than anyone gave her credit for. It was necessary. One could not rise to her rank without careful strategy. Every plan contained a safeguard and every deviation held an opportunity. And Entrapta was a very welcome deviation.

All those years ago Shadow Weaver had no idea that when she went to confront the kings of Dryl for theft she would be leaving with their princess. It was all too easy to work from there. The kings of Dryl died in an accident a few years after giving up their daughter leaving an empty throne. Forcing the princess's dependency was easy enough. All Shadow Weaver had to do was wait for the perfect time, help Entrapta reclaim her birthright, and enjoy a life of power behind her puppet monarch.

However, Entrapta's frustratingly high level of intrinsic motivation forced the sorceress to seek out other opportunities in the meantime. It wasn't difficult. From an early age Entrapta, like her fathers, showed a clear talent for invention. So she made the girl useful.

Shadow Weaver pretended not to notice Lord Hordak's frequent extended absences from his sanctum, the way his hand hovered over the purple crystal adorning his new armor, or Entrapta's sudden boost in confidence. The large footprints near the base of

the tower were easy enough to ignore, as was the crimson cape Entrapta had hastily shoved beneath her cot.

Yes, Shadow Weaver thought she knew exactly what was going on between the Lord of the Fright Zone and her captive princess. And she was content to let them have their fun. It might even benefit her all the more in the end. An alliance between Dryl and the Fright Zone would be even easier to secure when the time came. And until then Shadow Weaver had an excellent source of leverage to wield should Lord Hordak start to see her as a threat. At least that's what she thought.

There was a near miss one afternoon when Shadow Weaver arrived before Hordak had left. The two lovers were getting careless and lost track of time. Entrapta's shrill laughter told Shadow Weaver that the princess wasn't alone. She concealed herself within the tree line and waited to avoid discovery and inevitable confrontation. And it was there that Shadow Weaver couldn't help overhearing something interesting.

Entrapta and Lord Hordak weren't just enjoying frivolous midnight trysts. They were plotting and had been for some time. From what Entrapta could tell she was two, maybe three days away from breaking the spell on the tower, to ruining the sorceress's plans completely. Shadow Weaver lost herself in a senseless fury. No one steals from the sorceress. Something had to be done. The sorceress lay in wait until her ward was alone, stood beneath the tower, and called,

"Entrapta, Entrapta,

Let down your hair."

No sooner had Shadow Weaver reached the top than she began demanding answers from her ungrateful ward. Entrapta denied everything at first but realized all too late she was cornered. But to the sorceress's irritation, rather than retreating in fear, Entrapta argued back. Clearly, she had to be taught a lesson. In her anger, she seized Entrapta's hair with one hand grabbed a pair of scissors with the other, and snip, snap the hair was cut off. She then banished Entrapta to the desolate wasteland of Beast Island where she would see what good freedom did her. But that only took care of the first half of her problem. That same day the sorceress returned to the tower and fastened the hair near the window.

That evening when Hordak returned to the tower it worried him to see that Entrapta's hair was not behaving the way it normally did. Was there another accident? The thought sent a shiver down his spine. He hoisted himself up quickly needing to reassure himself that she was alright. But to his horror, Entrapta was nowhere to be found.

"Here to fetch your little caged bird?" Shadow Weaver mocked him.

Hordak charged his arm cannon, snarling at the witch. "Where is she?"

Shadow Weaver laughed. "What does it matter? After all, you'll never see her again."

Hordak's breath hitched. No. No it couldn't be. Entrapta. She was so close to escaping. She couldn't be… He raised his cannon aiming directly for Shadow Weaver's head. He knew her magic was strong. He knew she could best him. He didn't care. The warlord roared. "What have you done with Entrapta? Tell me!"

The sorceress drew a sigil in the air. "She is lost to you, *my lord* ." Shadow Weaver sneered behind the mask. "Forever." Before Hordak could fire Shadow Weaver activated the sigil throwing Hordak from the tower. He crashed to the forest floor, broken, agonized, but alive. Shadow Weaver did intend to go back for Entrapta once she felt the princess had learned her lesson. And she would have if a new threat had not descended upon the world making her forget the princess entirely.

He Wandered Quite Blind

In the clone's opinion (*which he Did. Not. Have.*) Etheria was a miserable planet. This was not because of its landscape or inhabitants. Both were unremarkable in comparison to the other worlds conquered by Lord Prime. Rather it was the way the planet affected him. Familiar flashes of a life he had (*Not*) lived plagued the clone the moment he set foot on the planet. The woods especially tortured his mind. Among the trees, his mind conjured up the image of an old tower (*that he did not know the location of)* and it set his mind reeling with loss every time *.*

Thanks to Prime's blessed mercy the clone had been assigned to an island far from that wicked forest. It was his privilege to scour the island for evidence of an ancient race called the first ones and report his findings. Yet to the clone's disappointment, the island only unbalanced him further. A constant ringing assaulted the clone's ears scrambling his connection to the hive mind and forcing dormant memories (*that could not be his*) to the surface.

He tried to focus only on moving forward through the dense purple fog, like her hair, like the crystal she gave up for him. Only for him to let her die at the hands of her captor. No! The clone shook the intrusion away. The island was playing tricks. The clone was loyal. He always had been. It would not win. He stepped into a clearing illuminated by the plant life which had, he guessed, developed some form of symbiotic relationship with the technology scattered here by the first ones. The clone investigated the foliage but found nothing worth reporting. The ringing started again, louder now that the clone was in the thick of the forest. He caught the faintest whiff of ozone and his mind brought him back to his sanctum. Broken as he was he managed to finish the portal thanks to her notes. The signal went through,

thank Prime. He could not bear to remain on this planet any longer. Not when-

More deception. The clone growled. Once Lord Prime finished conquering this ridiculous planet the clone would be to be rid of it. A branch snapped behind him and the clone whirled around just in time to see a humanoid form retreating towards the center of the island. Odd. According to the inhabitants of this planet, this island was uninhabitable by all but Etheria's most primitive life forms. Unless that was a lie meant to hide a rebellion encampment. This surely was worth investigating. The clone moved forward in quiet pursuit.

The Etherian carried a bundle of scrap and wires in her arms. Likely for a weapon, the clone thought. She was clearly worried about being followed. She stepped carefully, opting for terrain where she would not leave footprints while constantly scanning her surroundings. But the clone managed to avoid her notice. The Etherian led him to the entrance of a cave shrouded with dead vines. A wailing sound echoed from within that made her short hair briefly stand on end. When it started the clone assumed it to be the ringing of the island and braced himself for another onslaught of false phantoms. But nothing came of it. In fact, this noise was a different pitch entirely.

The woman rushed into the cavern only stopping long enough to set down her bundle of scraps. The cave was well hidden but not very deep. Neither she nor the clone tailing her had to travel far to find the source of the noise.

The clone was horrified by what he saw. Somehow this Etherian had managed to sneak into a cloning chamber, decant two clones

before they were ready, and make off with them. The Etherian was trying to calm a terrible wailing coming from one of them. Clearly, he was distressed by his cruel separation from his brothers. But wait… that wasn't right. These small creatures were not clones. They could not be. Yet he could not say they were Etherian either. The clone, forgetting stealth entirely, stepped forward to examine closer. The woman heard him. She gasped jumping to her feet and positioning herself between the clone and the two not clones. Someone yelled behind him and then everything went black.

Entrapta spent her first days on Beast Island barely surviving. Trying to navigate the hostile environment was difficult enough. She would have succumbed to the island long ago if Micah hadn't found her. He was kind, though a tad addled from being on the island for so long. Still, they understood eachother well enough. They had isolation in common after all. Micah told her he was once a king. But he got captured and banished here after a mission went awry. He had a wife and daughter on the mainland that he missed terribly and hoped to reunite with someday.

They set up a camp where Micah brought whatever food he could find while Entrapta worked to build something that could get them off the island. And when Entrapta discovered that she was pregnant Micah helped her through that too. She gave birth to a pair of healthy twins that she cherished with her entire being. She named the girl Dawn and the boy Dusk. Entrapta told them stories of their father and how they would find him again someday. It never occurred to her that he might find them first.

Her Tears Fell Upon His Eyes

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Entrapta did not recognize Hordak immediately. But she was sure it was him… well… at least eighty percent sure. Unfortunately, she hadn't recognized him fast enough to stop Micah from protecting her and the twins. It took a lot of convincing to stop Micah from outright killing him but they compromised. Micah would let Probably Hordak live so long as they restrained him long enough to find out if he was Actually Hordak and what he was doing here. They tied him to a tree just outside the cave while he was still unconscious and Entrapta took a moment to observe just how much he had changed. All traces of his armor were replaced with a stark robe that made him look sickly and his hair had changed from deep blue to shock white. What happened to him?

The phantom that haunted his thoughts was there when the clone opened his eyes. No, not a phantom. This time he could see her clearly, fully, as beautiful as the day he lost her. A tether in the back of his mind tugged at his thoughts keeping him from- *He. Would. Not. Be. Tricked.* The clone snarled attempting to break free of his restraints. Whatever these rebels planned for him it would not work. Even if they killed him it would not matter. Lord Prime would prevail.

The Etherian woman knelt to his level on the ground. "Hordak?" The broken hope in her voice gave the clone pause. What strange sort of magic allowed her to affect him this way? He wanted to roar at her, demand she leave him be. But he could never. Not to…

“Entrapta” Her name, the clone didn’t know how he knew but it was her name, escaped his lips as the faintest whisper. Still, she heard it. Entrapta attempted to blink away tears from her magenta eyes. Eyes that the clone knew he could stare into forever. “It’s you.” And the tether snapped.

He knew her. Hordak knew her. His heart, his love, his beautiful Entrapta stood before him alive and crying and he hated that he could not embrace her. He could scarcely believe it. The whole time she was here on this island surviving along with… Stars! Those dear little creatures. Those were his children! There was so much he wanted to say to her, so much he thought he had lost the chance to say. But all he could manage was “Can I see them?”

The moment he was untied Hordak and Entrapta pulled eachother into a tight embrace and would not let go. She introduced him to Dawn and Dusk and Hordak loved them immediately. Hordak could never thank Micah enough for helping his family and swore he would make sure the king got back to his. They made it to the mainland and reunited with Imp and Emily who were ecstatic to meet their new siblings. The future was uncertain. But Hordak and Entrapta had eachother. They had their family. And nothing would tear them apart again.

Chapter End Notes

If you made it this far thanks for bearing with me. If there's another tale you want to see let me know. It could make for a fun little series.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!